Study Builder Quick Start

Nov 8, 2026

Before you start

Study Builder is a web page that turns each week's learning objectives into a study plan: objectives you rewrite in your own words, key terms you define, flashcards that come back on a schedule, a checklist of readings and due dates, and a day-by-day plan to the next exam. You do not install anything or make an account.

Please read first. This is not an official University of Arizona or course sanctioned study tool. Use at your own risk. It was made by a fellow student to help organize information and make studying easier. The first time you open it you will tick an **I agree** box to confirm you read this.

The one rule. Your work is saved in the browser you are using, on that one computer or phone. It will be there tomorrow, but not on a different device, and it disappears if you clear your browser history. So **export to Google Sheets at the end of every study session**. It takes one minute and the steps are in this guide.

Opening the Study Builder

There are two ways to open it. Use whichever you were given.

If you were given a link: click it. It opens like any website. Bookmark it so you always come back to the same copy in the same browser.

If you were given a file (it ends in `.html`, for example `study-builder.html`):

Device	What to do
Windows	Save the file somewhere you will find it again (Documents is fine). Double-click it. It opens in your usual browser (Edge or Chrome). If it opens in a text program instead, right-click the file, choose **Open with**, then **Microsoft Edge** or **Google Chrome**.

Device	What to do
Mac	Save the file to Documents. Double-click it; it opens in Safari. If a text program opens instead, right-click the file, choose **Open With**, then **Safari** or **Google Chrome**.
Phone or tablet	A plain file is awkward on a phone. Use the link version instead if you have one; it works in the phone's browser.

Keep using the same browser. Your work is saved inside the browser you used. If you opened it in Chrome on Monday and Safari on Tuesday, Tuesday will look empty. Pick one browser and stick with it, or use the Google Sheets export (below) to move between them.

After opening, you will see the disclaimer at the top. Read it and tick **I agree**. The rest of the page becomes usable.

Your first 10 minutes

The page has two halves. **Left side:** boxes where you type or paste things in. **Right side:** tabs that turn what you typed into study material. Everything saves as you type.

1. **Check the week.** The page opens on Week 3 as an example, with the objectives, key terms and due dates already filled in. To start a new week, click **+ Add week** above the boxes, then paste that week's objectives from the module into **Module learning objectives** and the discussion's into **Discussion learning objectives**, one per line.
2. **Paste the readings and due dates.** Put the week's reading list in **This week's readings**, one per line. Copy the *Graded Assessments* and *Due Dates* block from the weekly announcement and paste it, exactly as is, into **Graded assessments and due dates**. The page works out which line is which.
3. **Rephrase each objective.** Open the **Objectives** tab on the right. Under each objective are two boxes: *In my own words* and *How I would answer this*. Fill them in before you read the chapter: rewrite the objective, then write the answer you would give if it were an exam question. If you cannot do that yet, that is the one to read for first. Each objective you finish becomes a flashcard.

4. **Define the key terms.** Open the **Key terms** tab. Type a definition for each term in your own words with the book closed. Each term shows which objective it belongs to; the page guesses from the wording and you can change it with the dropdown. Each term you define becomes a flashcard.

That is the core of the tool. The AI steps below save you typing; the flashcards, checklist and plan tabs are what you come back to every day.

Writing your own flashcards. In the *Flashcard questions and answers* box, one card per line: `question | answer | objective | source | kind`. Only the question and answer are required (the `|` key is above Enter). Objective links the card to an objective (5, or D2 for a discussion objective); source is the page or section the answer comes from, so you know what to reread; kind is recall, understanding or application (leave it blank and the page guesses). Aim for a mix of the three kinds, and ask one thing per card.

Using the University of Arizona AI for the reading tasks

Three jobs in Study Builder can be handed to an AI: turning textbook screenshots into practice questions, pulling the key-terms list out of a screenshot, and matching key terms to objectives. You do not need your own AI account for any of them. Use the University's AI at genai.arizona.edu and sign in with your NetID. Keep it open in a second browser tab next to Study Builder.

All three jobs work the same way: **copy a prompt from Study Builder, paste it into the University AI, copy the AI's reply, paste it back.** Study Builder does the rest.

How to take a screenshot (you will need this for the first two jobs)

- Windows: **Windows key + Shift + S**, then drag a box around the textbook page. The picture is saved to your clipboard and to Pictures > Screenshots.
- Mac: **Command + Shift + 4**, then drag a box. The picture saves to your Desktop.

Job 1: Practice questions from a textbook page

1. Take screenshots of the textbook pages you want questions on (up to 4 per batch).
2. In Study Builder, on the *Enter the week* page, find **Make practice questions with the University AI**. Step 1 shows the prompt in a box. Click **Copy prompt**. If your browser blocks the copy, the text is selected for you: press Ctrl + C (Command + C on Mac).

3. Go to the genai.arizona.edu tab. Click in the message box and paste. Attach your screenshots with the chat's attach or image button (or paste the screenshots into the chat). Send.
4. When the reply appears, select all of it and copy. Back in Study Builder, paste into the box under step 3 (*Paste the AI's reply here*) and click **Read the reply**.
5. A list appears with a checkbox beside each question and term. Untick anything that is not from your reading, then click **Add selected to this week**. Questions become flashcards; terms go to your key-terms list.

Job 2: Key terms from the chapter's key-terms box

1. Screenshot the *Key Terms* box at the end of the chapter.
2. Under the **Key terms** box on the left, open **Pull the key terms from a screenshot with the University AI**. Click **Copy prompt**.
3. Paste the prompt into the University AI with the screenshot attached, send, and copy the reply.
4. Paste the reply into the box under step 3 and click **Read the reply**. The terms are added; ones you already have are skipped.

Job 3: Match key terms to objectives

1. Open the **Key terms** tab on the right and click **Match terms to objectives with the University AI**.
2. A prompt box appears; click **Copy prompt**. Paste it into the University AI (no screenshot needed this time) and send.
3. Copy the reply, paste it into the box under the button, click **Read the reply**. Each term's objective dropdown updates. Change any you disagree with.

If the University AI will not take an image: paste the text of the textbook page into the chat instead of the picture. The prompt still works.

If Study Builder says it could not read the reply: go back to the University AI and send this: *Please reply with one line per item in the form Q: question | answer and TERM: term | definition.* Then copy that reply and paste it instead.

Every study session

Tab	What to do there
Objectives	Each objective has two boxes (*In my own words*, *How I would answer this*) and three stars for how comfortable you are (1 = no clue yet, 3 = super comfortable). Fill the boxes before you read the chapter. One-star objectives go to the top of your focus list.
Key terms	Define each term in your own words with the book closed, rate it with the stars, and check the objective it is linked to (the page suggests one; change it with the dropdown).
Flashcards	Opens on *Due today*. For each card: type your answer in the box, press **Reveal**, compare with the model answer, then press **Right**, **Partly** or **Wrong**. Right = every point there; Partly = some missing; Wrong = contradicts it. Right cards come back less often (1, 2, 4, 8 days…), Partly comes back tomorrow, Wrong starts over. Each card shows its kind (Recall, Understanding or Application) and, when you gave one, the page or section it came from. A session line counts your right / partly / wrong, and when the due pile is empty you get a list of passages to reread. *Meaning → term* adds a reverse card for every term you have defined. Below the deck, **Where to focus** ranks your weakest objectives and key terms with a Practice button for each.
Checklist	Your readings, then graded items sorted by due date (all times are Tucson, AZ local time; past dates are hidden), then the objectives. Tick a reading when finished, an assignment when submitted, and an objective only when you can do it from memory.

Tab	What to do there
Plan	Shows what is not ready yet, a short *Tonight* list, and a day-by-day plan to your next exam. Pick the exam and which weeks it covers. The plan gives each objective a first pass (read, rephrase, write cards), repeats it with flashcards about 2 and 7 days later, and keeps the last day for repeats only.

Printing. The buttons at the top (*Print study guide*, *Print checklist*, *Print flashcards*) open a clean page and your browser's print window. Choose *Save as PDF* there if you want a file. The flashcard sheet prints as cards to cut out.

Quizlet. *Export flashcards to Quizlet* at the top copies all your cards and shows five steps: open quizlet.com/create-set, click Import, paste, set the separators to Tab and New line, create. Your cards then work in Quizlet's Learn and Test modes. The same button on the Flashcards tab exports just that week.

A good 20-minute session: Plan tab to see tonight's list, Flashcards until nothing is due, one or two objectives rephrased or ticked, then Export to Google Sheets.

Saving your work to Google Sheets

Do this at the end of every session. It is the only way to keep your work if you switch devices or clear your browser.

Save (1 minute)

1. Click **Export to Google Sheets** at the top of the page. A panel opens with your rows already copied and the steps listed.
2. Click the **sheets.new** link in the panel (or go to sheets.new). Sign in with your university Google account if asked.
3. Click the top-left cell, **A1**, and paste (Ctrl + V on Windows, Command + V on Mac). Everything fills in: every week's objectives, your rephrasings, terms and definitions, flashcards, readings, due dates and check marks.
4. Name the sheet, for example *MCB 410 Study Builder*. Next time, open the same sheet, click A1, and paste again over the old rows.

Get your work back (new computer, cleared browser, different browser)

1. Open your Google Sheet. Click the blank square above row 1 and to the left of column A to select everything. Copy.
2. In Study Builder, scroll to the bottom of the left side, open **Restore from a sheet**, paste into the box, click **Restore**.
3. All your weeks come back, check marks and definitions included.

Want it to save by itself instead? If you have a free claude.ai account, you can keep your own copy of Study Builder there and it saves your work to your account automatically, on every device, with no Sheets export needed. It takes one chat message to set up. The steps are in the *Study Builder Advanced Setup* guide under Option 1; they are short and you do not need to be technical to follow them.

Quick fixes

What you see	What to do
The page is greyed out and nothing works	Tick **I agree** under the notice at the top.
My work disappeared	You are in a different browser or computer, or browser data was cleared. Open the browser you used before, or restore from your Google Sheet.
The `.html` file opened as a page of code	Right-click the file, **Open with**, choose Edge, Chrome or Safari.
"Could not read the reply" after pasting	Copy the AI's whole answer, including the first line. Or ask the University AI to reply in the Q: / TERM: form (see the AI section) and paste that.
The University AI will not accept my screenshot	Paste the page text into the chat instead of the image.
Due date shows "No date"	Make sure the line has a month and day, like *Sunday November 15th*.
Nothing is due on the Flashcards tab	Good. Switch to *All cards* to keep practicing, or come back tomorrow.
The print window did not open	Press Ctrl + P (Command + P on Mac) while the print layout is showing.

If none of this helps, ask whoever shared the Study Builder with you, and include a screenshot of what you see and the name of your browser.